

HR Policies & Practices Handbook

1. Recruitment & Hiring

Open positions are first offered internally for 5 working days before external posting, except for specialized roles where no internal candidate is likely to qualify. The typical hiring pipeline is: resume screening, one technical assessment or take-home task, one technical interview, one HR/behavioral round, and a final offer discussion.

Reference checks are conducted for all final-stage candidates before an offer letter is issued. Offer letters are typically valid for acceptance within 7 calendar days.

2. Onboarding

New hires complete a structured 2-week onboarding period covering company policy orientation, tool/access provisioning, and role-specific shadowing with an assigned buddy. A 30-60-90 day check-in schedule is used to track early performance and address concerns before they become larger issues.

Probation period is standard for 3 months from the date of joining, extendable by up to 3 additional months at management's discretion if more evaluation time is needed.

3. Leave Policy

Casual leave: 10 days/year, credited at year start, does not carry forward, cannot be encashed on exit.

Sick leave: 12 days/year; a medical certificate is required beyond 2 consecutive days; up to 8 unused days may carry forward, capped at 16 accumulated days total.

Annual leave: 14 days/year after 12 months of continuous service; up to 5 unused days may carry forward with manager approval; otherwise forfeited at year-end.

Maternity leave: 12 weeks fully paid, requiring at least 4 months of continuous prior service; does not draw against other leave balances. Paternity leave: 2 weeks paid, to be availed within 1 month of the child's birth.

Public holidays follow the federally gazetted calendar. Employees performing Hajj may take up to 30 days of unpaid leave once during their tenure, with 60 days' advance notice.

4. Performance Management & Appraisals

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year (mid-year and annual), using a structured self-assessment followed by manager review against role-specific competencies and goals set at the start of the review period.

Annual salary revisions and promotions, where applicable, are tied to the annual review cycle rather than processed on an ad-hoc basis, except in cases of retention risk or significant scope change.

Employees rated below expectations for two consecutive review cycles are placed on a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) with clearly defined goals and a 60-90 day timeline.

5. Compensation & Payroll

Salaries are disbursed on the last working day of each month via direct bank transfer. Payslips itemizing basic salary, allowances, and any deductions (tax, provident fund) are issued alongside each payment.

The company contributes to EOBI for all confirmed employees as required by law, and matches voluntary provident fund contributions up to 8% of basic salary for employees with 1+ year of confirmed service.

6. Workplace Conduct & Grievance Redressal

The company maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, and retaliation. Employees may report concerns confidentially to HR directly or through an anonymous channel, and all reports are investigated within 15 working days.

A formal grievance procedure exists for disputes not related to harassment (e.g. disputes over appraisal ratings or leave denials): employees may escalate in writing to HR, who will convene a review within 10 working days.

7. Training & Development

Employees are entitled to a training/learning budget for job-relevant courses or certifications, subject to manager pre-approval. Internal knowledge-sharing sessions are held monthly, and attendance is counted toward informal development goals during appraisals.

8. Work-From-Home & Remote Work

Employees may take up to 2 work-from-home days per month with manager approval. Fully remote arrangements are evaluated case-by-case and require sign-off from both the manager and HR.

9. Notice Period & Offboarding

Probationary employees serve a 2-week notice period on resignation; confirmed employees serve 30 days, or may pay one month's basic salary in lieu, at the company's discretion. No notice or payment in lieu applies to termination for proven misconduct.

The offboarding process includes a mandatory exit interview, return of company assets, revocation of system access on the last working day, and final settlement (including any pending dues or leave encashment where applicable) within 30 days of the last working day.